

Module 14: Solutions, Governance, and the Future

Graduate Research Project

A Multi-Level Migration Solution: Comprehensive Policy Design

Overview

The graduate capstone: design a comprehensive solution to one migration challenge that integrates local, national, and international levels — engaging the Global Compact framework — with implementation and evaluation plans.

Aligned learning outcomes

- Design comprehensive migration solutions (Grad 1)
- Integrate multi-level approaches (Grad 2)

Sample research questions

- What is the precise problem, at what scale, affecting whom — and what do current governance instruments already provide?
- How do your local, national, and international components reinforce each other rather than merely coexist?
- What are the political-economy obstacles, and how does the design survive them?

Methods

Integrative policy design drawing on the full course: driver analysis (M4), data (M2), legal frameworks (M9), economics (M10), integration evidence (M13), and governance instruments (Global Compact for Migration, GCR). Includes implementation timeline, cost logic, risk register, and evaluation framework.

IRB / research ethics

Not required — design study.

Deliverables

- 6,000–8,000-word policy design paper
- Implementation and evaluation annex
- Conference-style 20-minute defense presentation

Grading rubric

Each criterion is scored at one of four levels, then weighted as shown. The overall grade is the weighted combination of criterion scores. Instructors may adapt weights and descriptors to local requirements.

Criterion (weight)	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D–F)
Problem definition and evidence base 25%	Evidence and accuracy are exemplary: problem definition and evidence base is met with high-quality, correctly cited sources for every substantive claim; terms, facts, and frameworks are used precisely.	Evidence and accuracy are solid: problem definition and evidence base is met for nearly all claims, with only minor sourcing gaps or imprecisions that do not affect conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are uneven: problem definition and evidence base is partly met — some claims lack support, sources are thin or misread, or terms are used loosely in ways that weaken conclusions.	Evidence and accuracy are deficient: problem definition and evidence base is not met; key claims are unsupported or wrong, and errors undermine the work's conclusions.
True multi-level integration — not three separate plans 30%	Analysis is genuinely insightful: true multi-level integration — not three separate plans goes beyond summary to produce non-obvious, well-defended conclusions; concepts are applied accurately, complexity is preserved, and counterpoints are engaged seriously.	Analysis is competent: true multi-level integration — not three separate plans is achieved with clear reasoning and accurate use of course concepts, though conclusions stay near the expected.	Analysis is thin: true multi-level integration — not three separate plans is attempted but leans on summary or assertion; concepts are named more than used, and complications are avoided.	Analysis is absent: true multi-level integration — not three separate plans is not achieved; the work describes without analyzing or draws conclusions its own material does not support.
Implementation realism, including politics 25%	Design judgment is excellent: implementation realism, including politics is fully addressed — costs, constraints, politics, and failure modes are named honestly and the proposal remains workable anyway.	Design judgment is good: implementation realism, including politics is addressed for the major factors, with minor blind spots that would not sink the proposal.	Design judgment is limited: implementation realism, including politics is addressed superficially — key constraints or failure modes are ignored, making the proposal fragile.	Design judgment is missing: implementation realism, including politics is not addressed; the proposal ignores obvious constraints and would not survive contact with reality.
Defense quality 20%	Performance under questioning is outstanding: defense quality shows command of the material, direct engagement with hard questions, and revision that visibly improved the work.	Performance is solid: defense quality shows good command and reasonable answers to challenges, with revision addressing the main feedback.	Performance is shaky: defense quality shows incomplete command — questions deflected or answered vaguely, revision cosmetic.	Performance is inadequate: defense quality shows the student could not explain or defend their own work, and feedback was not incorporated.